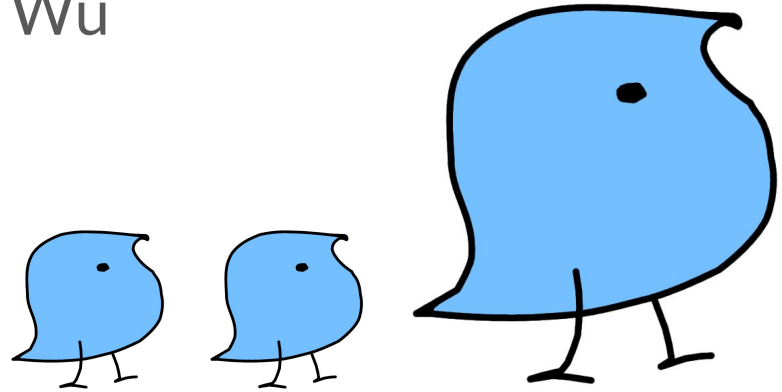


Why study linguistics?

LING 101
Yvette Yi-Chi Wu



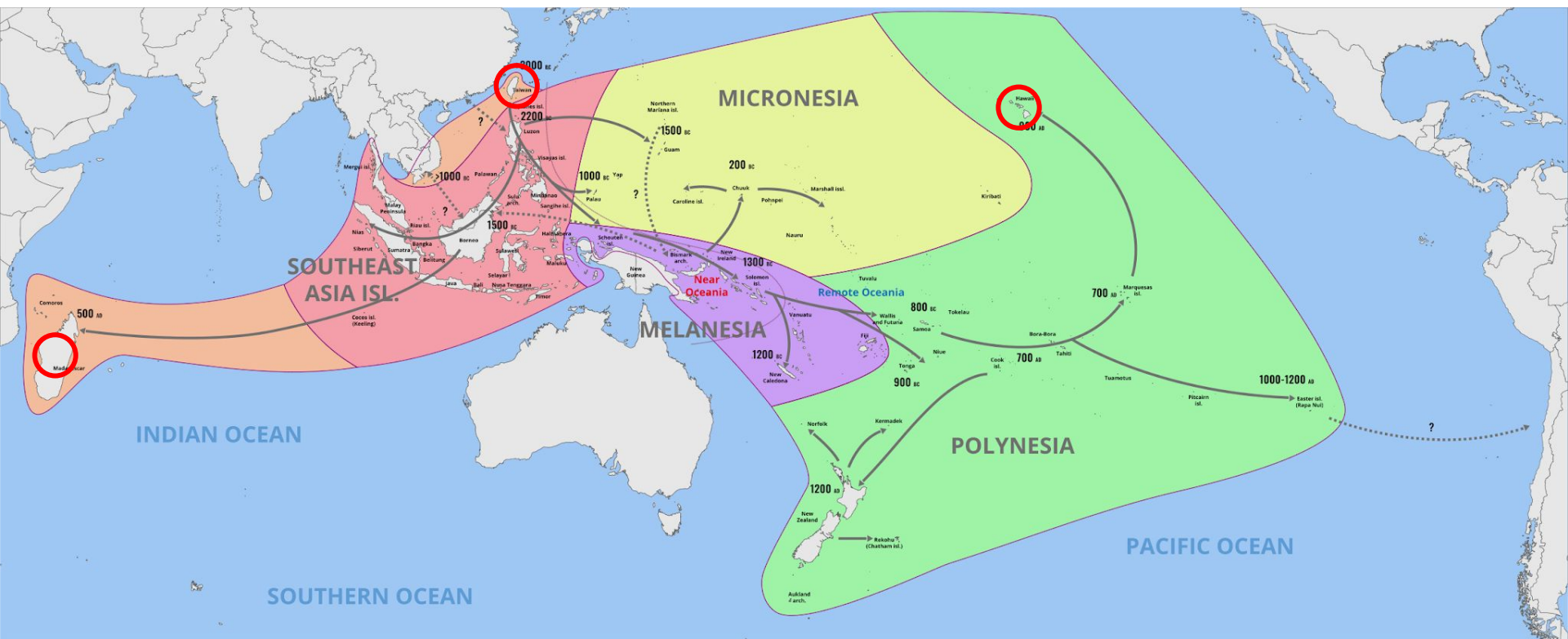
What is linguistics relevant for?

- Why study phonetics, phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics?

What is linguistics relevant for?

- Why study phonetics, phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics?
- A **historical** perspective:
language families, migration patterns, archaeological similarities

Austronesian language family



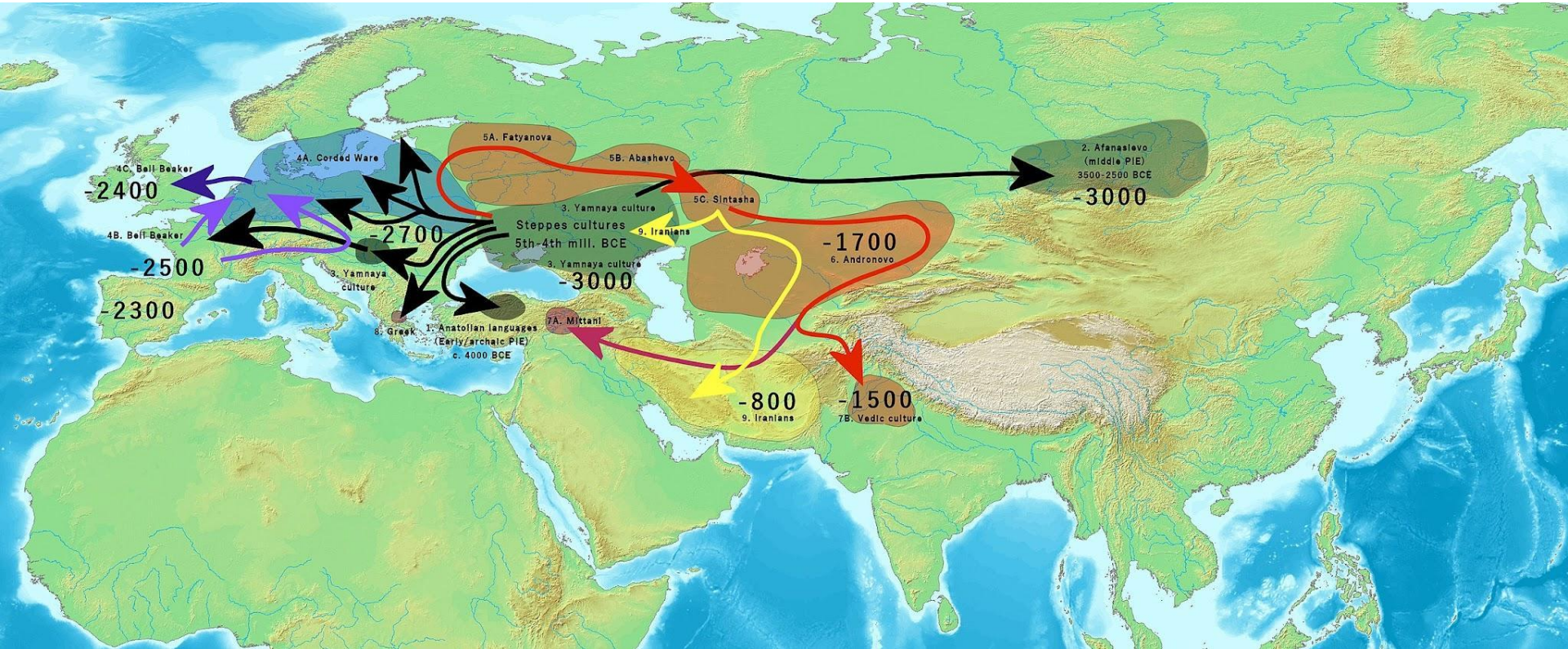
the number 'five':

Seediq: [rima]

Hawaiian: [elima]

Malagasy: [dimy]

Indo-European language family



time depth of migration simulated through language change

What is linguistics relevant for?

- Why study phonetics, phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics?
- A **historical** perspective:
language families, migration patterns, anthropological similarities
- A **computational** and **technological** perspective:
natural language processing, search engines, voice assistants, translation, etc.



Let's ask google translate:

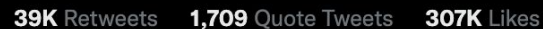
- I want 10 songs.
- I want 1997 songs.



Let's ask Siri:

- Play any Bad Bunny song.
- Play any song that is not Bad Bunny.

<https://labs.openai.com/>



What is linguistics relevant for?

- Why study phonetics, phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics?
- A **historical** perspective:
language families, migration patterns, anthropological similarities
- A **computational** and **technological** perspective:
natural language processing, search tools, voice assistants, translation, etc.
- A **sociological** perspective:
speech style, dialectal variation, accents, ideas of “correctness”, standardization

A Brief History of 'Cursive Singing', From Amy Winehouse to TikTok

Characterised by stretching vowel sounds way beyond what is necessary, the decade has given us a bounty of "cursive singers", AKA vocalists doing the r

 By [Jumi Akinfenwa](#)

July 21, 2020, 7:10am   



CULTURE

From Upspeak To Vocal Fry: Are We 'Policing' Young Women's Voices?

July 23, 2015 · 1:49 PM ET

Heard on [Fresh Air](#)

Language in Society **46**, 339–370.
doi:10.1017/S0047404517000070

Gender as stylistic bricolage: Transmasculine voices and the relationship between fundamental frequency and /s/

L A L Z I M M A N

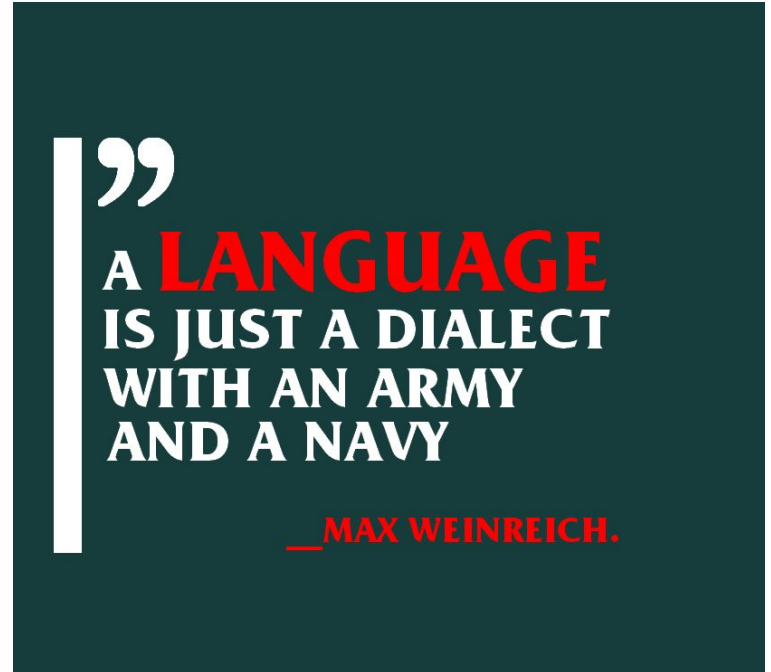
University of California, Santa Barbara, USA

ABSTRACT

Despite the importance of gender differences in the voice, sociolinguists have not paid sufficient attention to the sociolinguistic processes through which phonetic resources are mobilized in the construction of a gendered voice. This article argues that gender differences in the voice—including those influenced by physiology—are best understood as elements of sociolinguistic style rather than static properties. With a focus on transgender speakers in the early stages of masculinizing hormone therapy, the analysis demonstrates the complex interrelationship of the gendered meanings attributable to characteristics like fundamental frequency and /s/. Trans speakers challenge systems for categorizing voices as female or male, which assume that different aspects of the gendered voice will pattern together in normative ways. Yet

What is considered a language?

- mutual intelligibility between Danish, Norwegian and Swedish
- mutual intelligibility between Hindi and Urdu
- *lack* of mutual intelligibility between Chinese “dialects”



THE REAL EBONICS DEBATE

Power,
Language,
and the
Education of
African-American
Children

DANGER
EDUCATED
BLACK
MAN

A SPECIAL ISSUE OF *RETHINKING SCHOOLS*
GUEST EDITED BY THERESA PERRY & LISA DELPIT

Rethinking Schools is pleased to present this special issue, *The Real Ebonics Debate: Language, Power, and the Education of African-American Children*. For the first time in the history of *Rethinking Schools*, guest editors have solicited and written the articles, and overseen editorial content from inception to implementation.

Perhaps more than any other debate in education, the study of language overlaps with questions of

Perry and Lisa Delpit approached *Rethinking Schools* with the proposal to guest edit this issue on Ebonics. Both are well-respected educators with a long history of challenging educational practices that are a dis-service to African-American students.

As Lisa Delpit notes in her article, one cannot be for or against Ebonics. It exists. It is the language many African-American children hear¹ as their mothers raised them and shared their dreams with

did little to clarify the misunderstandings about the history of the language or to help educators develop curriculum. Delpit, Perry, and the other writers in this volume offer background history that excavates the race and power dynamics surrounding the development of the language, and discuss how an understanding of Ebonics may affect classroom practice. We believe it is especially important that white educators carefully consider their arguments.



Jackson supports Oakland Ebonics

In reverse, he says
school board action
was misunderstood



Does this bother you? It should. We've spent over 400 years fighting for the right to have a voice. In this house we'll use it. More importantly, in this house we'll teach our children to use it. If we expect dreams of them, we must not throw our hands to the air and agree with those who say our children cannot be taught. Be sure, you've probably heard about Ebonics

(aka, Black English). And if you think it's become a controversy because white America doesn't want us mixing with their prestige language, don't. White America couldn't care less what we do to segregate ourselves.

The fact is language is power. And we can't take that power away from our children with Ebonics. Would Dr. Martin Luther King,

Malcolm X and all the others who paid the price of obtaining our voice with the currency of their lives endorse that? If you haven't read your voice lately, consider this an invitation.

**SPEAK OUT AGAINST
EBONICS**

This message brought to you by Ebonics & Black Professionals.

What is linguistics relevant for?

- Why study phonetics, phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics?
- A **historical** perspective:
language families, migration patterns, anthropological similarities
- A **computational** and **technological** perspective:
natural language processing, search tools, voice assistants, translation, etc.
- A **sociological** perspective:
dialectal variation, accents, ideas of “correctness”, standardization
- A **philosophical** and **anthropological** perspective:
communication, meaning and pragmatics, verbal art, what makes us human?